DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 2

WordPress developer

Profession 2 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A WordPress developer builds and customises websites on WordPress, the open-source content management system that powers a large share of the web. The work ranges from setting up a site with a theme to writing custom plugins and child themes.

What professionals do every day

Installs and configures WordPress, chooses and customises themes, adds plugins, creates content types, sets up hosting and security, and maintains sites with backups and updates.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Most small businesses want a site they can edit themselves. WordPress gives them that, and a developer makes it fast, secure, and designed for their customers.

- Sites that are hard to edit or update.
- Slow pages and weak security from poorly chosen plugins.
- Custom features such as booking, courses or product catalogues.

Skills you need

- How WordPress works: pages, posts, themes, plugins and the database.
- HTML, CSS and some PHP for custom code.
- Child themes and safe customisation.
- Hosting, backups, security and performance.
- SEO basics (see Marketing department).

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
WordPress.org	Open-source software to install yourself	Free	Hosting costs only	wordpress.org
WordPress.com	Hosted WordPress service	Free plan	Paid plans	wordpress.com
Local	Run WordPress on your own computer for testing	Free	Paid tiers	localwp.com
Wordfence / security plugins	Security scanning and firewall	Free version	Paid plans	www.wordfence.com
UpdraftPlus	Backups	Free version	Paid plans	updraftplus.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Install WordPress locally; build pages with the block editor; learn themes and plugins.
Intermediate	Create child themes; edit templates; add custom CSS and simple PHP snippets with care.
Advanced	Build custom post types, performance tuning, security hardening and a staging workflow.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** A five-page business site with a contact form and a backup schedule.
- **Intermediate:** A custom booking page using a plugin and a child theme.
- **Advanced:** A membership or course site with user roles and payments.

Client-ready portfolio project

A complete business site with a child theme, staging copy, backups, performance and security settings, and a handover document for the client.

Worked example

Worked example. Changing a button colour is done in the child theme's `style.css`, never the parent theme. The parent can then update without losing the change.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Build a five-page bakery site on WordPress with a child theme

Business problem: A bakery needs a home, menu, about, contact and order page, a child theme for custom styling, and a plan for updates.

Steps

1. Install WordPress on a local or hosted test site (see official install guide).
2. Choose a block theme and activate it. Create the pages Home, Menu, About, Contact and Order.
3. Create a child theme folder named `bakery-child` with the `style.css` shown, and activate it.
4. Add a hero section with class `bakery-hero` to the Home page.
5. Install one backup plugin and one security plugin; record the settings used.

Expected output: Five published pages, a working child theme, the hero styling visible on the home page, and a short maintenance note.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The child theme keeps your changes separate, so theme updates do not erase them. The header's *Template* line must match the folder name of the installed parent theme (here twentytwentyfour, the default block theme; check your installed version). Activating the child theme and seeing the hero

background proves it works. Maintenance note: schedule weekly backups, update plugins after testing on a copy, and keep administrator accounts to two people.

CSS

```
/*
Theme Name: Bakery Child
Template: twentytwentyfour
Description: Child theme for the bakery site. Keeps customisations safe during updates.
Version: 1.0
*/
/* Custom styles go below. The parent theme name must match an installed theme. */
.bakery-hero { background: #fff7e8; padding: 40px 16px; text-align: center; }
```

Common mistakes

- Editing the parent theme directly, which is lost on update.
- Installing many plugins; each one adds risk and slowness.
- Working on a live site without a staging copy or a backup.
- Using 'nulled' (pirated) themes or plugins, which can contain malware.

Freelancing opportunities

- Small business websites, landing pages and maintenance plans.
- Fixing and speeding up existing sites.
- Freelance marketplace projects: search 'WordPress', 'Elementor', 'WooCommerce'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- WordPress official documentation
- WordPress developer handbook: child themes
- WordPress Learn (official courses)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Development and IT**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.